

Preliminary Research (Backend)

Some tools already doing similar things:

- Jira
 - There's Jira, which basically tracks tasks and blockers. So backend-wise I'm thinking we'd need some structured data like users, tasks, and statuses.
- Slack
 - There's Slack, where people use bots for daily standups. That makes me think we could do something event-based, like sending notifications or reminders automatically.

Backend tools we could use:

- Node.js + Express (simple API)
- PostgreSQL (store users and updates)
- Firebase (easier option - auth and database included)

For backend tools, I'm leaning towards Node.js with Express since it's simple and easy to build APIs. For the database, PostgreSQL makes sense for storing users and updates in a structured way. But Firebase could also be nice if we want something quicker since it already has auth and database built in.

Basic backend features we need:

- User login and signup
- Submit daily update
- Store updates per user per day
- Teams (group users together)
- Reminders
- Simple analytics (who didn't check in, blockers, etc.)

In terms of features, I feel like we definitely need basic stuff like user login and signup. Then users should be able to submit a daily update, and we store that per user per day. We also need teams so we can group users together.

User Story

As a backend developer on a software team, I want to track daily updates, blockers, and team activity in one place, so that I can understand overall team progress and quickly identify issues without needing constant meetings.

User Persona

Bio:

Kevin is a 21-year-old computer science student and backend developer working on a small agile team for a class project.

Lifestyle:

He balances school, projects, and internship prep, so his schedule is busy and inconsistent. He prefers working asynchronously and doesn't always have time for frequent meetings. Most of his work happens in short, focused sessions throughout the day, and he relies on tools like Slack and Jira to stay updated.

Goals:

- Quickly log updates without interrupting workflow
- See what teammates are doing at any time
- Identify blockers early so the team doesn't fall behind

Frustrations:

- Forgetting to send updates or check-ins
- Too many unnecessary meetings
- Lack of visibility into what teammates are working on